BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
AIR EDUCATION AND TRAINING COMMAND

AIR EDUCATION AND TRAINING COMMAND INSTRUCTION 38-403

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Manpower and Organization

INNOVATION GOVERNANCE

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This instruction implements Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 38-4, Continuous Improvement and Airmen Powered by Innovation Program. It provides guidance to foster innovation and provide accountability to the innovator within Air Education and Training Command (AETC). This instruction creates a process for AETC to approve, track, and establish MAJCOM level innovations towards becoming programs of record. This instruction aims to encourage a culture of innovation, empower Airmen to think creatively, and provide a framework for implementing innovative practices throughout the command. This instruction applies to the Total Force – Active Duty (AD) Air Force (AF), Air Force Reserve (AFR), Air National Guard (ANG), and Department of the Air Force (DAF) Civilians when requesting AETC funding for innovation. This publication does not apply to the United States Space Force (USSF). Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using the DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*; route DAF Forms 847 through the appropriate chain of command. This AETCI may not be supplemented at any level. The authorities to waive wing/unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-1, T-2, T-3") number following the compliance statement. See Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate tier waiver approval

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1. Overview.

1.1. The purpose of this instruction is to provide a governance framework for AETC innovation; to define responsibilities, process, pathways, and off-ramps at the various levels of innovation across AETC. In addition, this guidance establishes a command-wide processes to align innovation initiatives with command strategy and resources.

1.2. AETC defines innovation as the deliberate development of previously non-existent processes, practices, or products that enhance air education, training, and recruiting while directly supporting and/or enhancing the command's strategic lines of effort (LOE).

1.3. AETC uses innovation to solve identified "gaps" and optimize current/future efforts. At the MAJCOM level, these gaps represent enterprise deficiencies or vulnerabilities that apply across multiple mission entities. Base-level and below entities can locally manage gaps and solutions by utilizing local resources.

1.4. AETC Leadership, Directorate, and Wing sponsored innovation initiatives will take priority for staff monitoring and visibility. Innovation owning organizations will appoint a single point of contact, an Innovation Initiative Lead (IIL), to interface with higher headquarters. IILs will manage initiatives throughout the innovation lifecycle.

1.5. AETC support may include funding, advocacy, and sponsorship. AETC support of an innovation initiative is not a guarantee of funding.

1.6. AETC utilizes the USAF standard VISION platform (**https://vision.il4.afwerx.dso.mil**) to track innovation related activities. VISION stands for Virtual Innovation Support Integration Operations Network. VISION is a strategic coordination suite that allows end-to-end services such as project and initiative entry, management, education, team establishment, collaboration,

chat, analytics, task, and risk management, as well as lifecycle tracking of innovation and improvement concepts and ideas.

2. Responsibilities.

2.1. AETC Futures Innovation and Strategy (AETC/A5X) will:

2.1.1. Identify and communicate strategic gaps and potential innovation areas of focus.

2.1.2. Ensure enterprise innovation aligns with Commander, AETC (AETC/CC) priorities.

2.1.3. AETC/A5X communicates areas to the MAJCOM where AETC/CC deems direct innovation should occur at the conclusion of a gap analysis.

2.1.4. AETC/A5X will identify requirements needing AETC funding to AETC Command Financial Analysis (AETC/FMA) during applicable financial drill.

2.2. AETC Innovation (AETC/A5XI) will:

2.2.1. Serve as the AETC lead for innovation and program support.

2.2.2. Align AETC enterprise innovation initiatives with AETC strategy and LOEs. Utilize the rubric provided in **Attachment 2** to assess the initiatives effectiveness and priority.

2.2.3. Provide standardized guidance and support for innovation initiatives and programs as outlined in this instruction.

2.2.4. Coordinate and deconflict innovation efforts across AETC's innovation ecosystem and facilitate collaboration and knowledge sharing to avoid duplication of effort, promoting best practices throughout the command. **Paragraph 6** details the Innovation Ecosystem.

2.2.5. Manage the AETC Innovation Process.

2.2.6. Conduct updates with Innovation Initiative Leads as required.

2.2.7. Assist with bi-annual enterprise level gap and problem statement assessments and disseminate to all subordinate levels.

2.2.8. Review and validate identified gaps through the AETC Requirement Validation Process as outlined in AETCI 10-602, *AETC Capability Requirements Development*.

2.2.9. Manage and execute AETC directed innovation campaigns to identify innovative solutions for specific identified gaps in AETC strategy.

2.2.10. Educate Wing Spark Cells on innovation frameworks and techniques.

2.2.11. Lead AETC Spark Tank, innovation competitions, and Spark Cell efforts.

2.2.12. Coach AETC aligned innovations through the innovation process to compete for innovation funds and support.

2.2.13. Chair the Commercial Capabilities Integration & Transition (CCIT) team.

2.2.13.1. CCIT will monitor solutions and build decision briefs for AETC/A5X and the AETC/A5/8 Director. CCIT will recommend innovation projects and gap solutions to AETC/A5X for continuation, down selecting and/or cancellation. The Director of

AETC/A5/8 is the decision authority for AETC innovation efforts going forward or efforts cancelled.

2.2.13.2. CCIT will assist IILs to "off ramp" their innovation initiatives when the project is not ready, needs further development, or is rejected by the process.

2.2.13.3. CCIT will brief the requirements oversight council (ROC) on an as-needed basis, but at least annually, the following information:

2.2.13.3.1. Number of initiatives in VISION.

2.2.13.3.2. Status of existing initiatives.

2.2.13.3.3. New initiatives since last brief.

2.2.13.3.4. Application to validated gap requirements.

2.2.13.4. The CCIT team will consist of, but not limited to, the following organization representatives:

2.2.13.4.1. AETC/A5XI (CCIT Chair)

2.2.13.4.2. AETC Rapid Development Branch and Acquisitions (AETC/A5QE)

2.2.13.4.3. AETC Programming (AETC/A8PP)

2.2.13.4.4. AETC Tech Training Requirements (AETC/A5RT)

2.2.13.4.5. AETC/A5/8 (Senior Advisor for Business Operations)

2.2.13.4.6. AETC Contracting Organization Representative (i.e. 338 Enterprise Sourcing Squadron (ESS))

2.2.13.4.7. AETC Future Operations (AETC/A3X)

2.2.13.4.8. AETC Strategic Portfolio Management (AETC/A6CR)

2.2.13.4.9. AETC Strategy (AETC/A6FS)

2.2.13.4.10. AETC Financial Management (AETC/FM)

2.3. Wing/Base Level will:

2.3.1. Establish installation innovation program and Spark Cell (see "Spark Generator" in VISION platform for Spark Cell Plan example).

2.3.2. Appoint Spark Lead(s) to guide and coordinate innovation initiatives and provide HQ appointment memo for continuity and innovation POC directory. Submit to **AETC.A5XI.Innovation@us.af.mil**.

2.3.3. Report all innovation initiatives, to include idea prioritization, gaps, and/or solutions to AETC/A5XI.

2.3.4. Report all Small Business Innovation Research and Small Business Technology Transfer (SBIR/STTR) accepted/awarded proposals and notify AETC/A5XI when SBIR/STTR proposals enters phase II.

2.3.5. Report Squadron Innovation Funds (SIF) dispersals for the fiscal year from assigned organizations to AETC/A5XI and AETC/FM.

2.4. Spark Cell will:

2.4.1. Facilitate and guide the innovation process within the organization to support identification of improvement opportunities, spark creativity, and develop new and groundbreaking ideas. Spark Cell leads should have experience with facilitating small to large group discussions on a variety of topics and exhibit strong communication skills, both written and verbal, as well as conflict resolution.

2.4.2. Champion and execute innovation initiatives that support the local mission and broader strategic vision of AETC.

2.4.3. Identify and empower individuals within the Wing/Base to act as innovation champions, promoting a culture of continuous improvement.

2.4.4. Establish communication channels for gathering ideas from personnel, providing feedback, and refining proposals before escalating to higher levels.

2.4.5. Foster cross functional collaboration among different units within the Wing/Base to share knowledge, skills, and lessons learned in innovation endeavors.

2.4.6. Determine if an idea is an innovation or a Continuous Process Improvement (CPI), as defined in DAFI 38-401, *Continuous Process Improvement (CPI)*. Processes improvements are not necessarily innovation.

2.4.6.1. Advise on appropriate pathway to completion.

2.4.6.2. If the process requires innovation, work through at the local Spark Cell.

2.4.6.3. If initiative is CPI, relay to base Wing Process Manager and contact AETC/A5XI to determine if the CPI is a benchmark to potentially implement across the command.

2.4.7. Monitor and manage all innovation initiatives at the local installation and ensure documentation of proposed initiatives in the VISION platform.

2.5. Squadron/Unit will:

2.5.1. Identify any initiative that could scale up to the enterprise level.

2.5.2. Upload all innovation solutions in the VISION platform. Update content regularly.

2.6. AETC Innovation Initiative Lead (IIL) will:

2.6.1. Serve as the main Point of Contact from the innovation initiative owning organization.

2.6.2. Conduct innovation training prescribed by AETC/A5X.

2.6.3. All Innovation Initiative Leads will notify AETC/A5XI of innovation initiatives at **AETC.A5XI.Innovation@us.af.mil**.

2.6.4. Confirm proposed solutions do not already exist in innovation ecosystem.

2.6.5. Place innovation initiatives into the VISION web application.

2.6.5.1. Safeguard Information. Prior to sharing any information or data with an external information system or non-US government entity, all AETC Airmen will

utilize their local chain of command to determine if there are any security vulnerabilities that domestic and/or foreign adversaries could exploit.

2.6.5.2. VISION is the platform for the command to track innovation related activities. The initiative must have all applicable information filled out to include: Team lead, Technical POC or Spark Cell Lead, Manager, Collaborators, Command Sponsor within AETC (Wing/CC, etc.), and Unit Location.

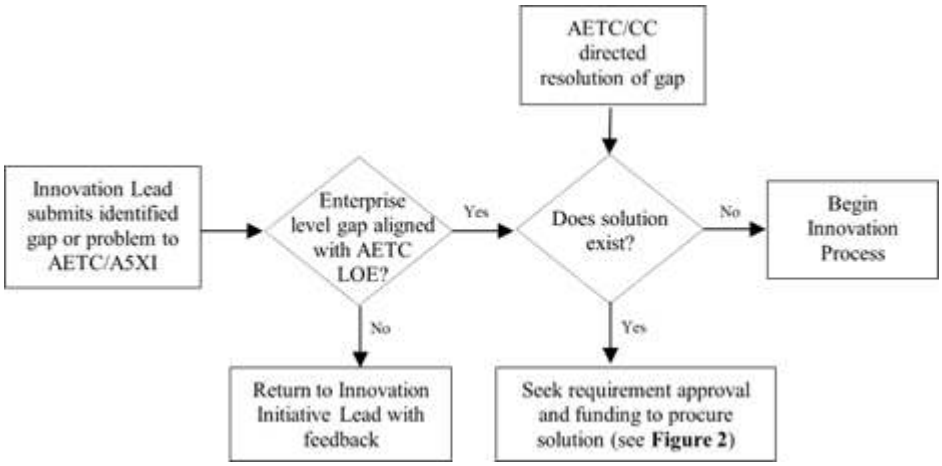
2.6.6. Manage innovation initiatives throughout the innovation lifecycle.

2.6.7. Track data and assist with analysis to assess the innovation's impact and effectiveness.

3. Innovation Process.

3.1. The innovation process is the framework for implementing innovative practices throughout the command. The first step is to determine if a solution exists for the identified gap or problem. AETC/A5XI is available to support the Innovation Initiative Lead in navigating innovation resources for solution determination. Innovations must align with the AETC/CC strategic LOEs. See **Figure 1**.

Figure 1. Innovation Process Determination.



3.2. Innovation Initiative Lead will utilize the Innovation Process when the proposed innovation initiative addresses a gap or problem without an existing government solution or commercially available product. DAFI 38-402, *Airmen Powered by Innovation and Suggestion Program* defines the AF Innovation Process. All successful innovative efforts start with an idea of how to solve the problem, and end with the goal of implementing the solution. The process involves taking risks and learning which occurs through analysis, assessment, and continuous improvement.

3.2.1. Analysis, Continuous Improvement, and Strategic Alignment. When an innovation initiative receives funding allocations, the IIL will conduct proper analysis documenting the success or failure of the initiative to inform higher level decisions.

3.2.1.1. IIL will analyze relevant data to assess the innovation's impact and effectiveness in addressing identified gaps.

3.2.1.2. IIL will track wins, barriers, and progress throughout the lifecycle of the initiative and report the data to AETC/A5XI.

3.2.1.3. IIL will input all data analysis and lessons learned into the VISION platform throughout the lifecycle of the initiative.

3.2.1.4. ILL will collaborate with AETC/A5XI, CCIT and AETC Analysis and Assessments (AETC/A9) to prepare status reports to maintain situational awareness throughout the lifecycle of the innovation.

3.2.2. Requirement Validation and Funding. Innovative Solutions at the enterprise level must compete for AETC funding for implementation. Without AETC funding or support, innovation efforts must obtain funding and sustainment at the local level within a Wing's baseline. To compete for AETC Funding, whether in execution year or Program Objective Memorandum (POM), the initiative must have a validated requirement.

3.2.2.1. AETC/A5XI is available to assist the IIL to gain solution approval through the AETC Requirement Validation Process defined in AETCI 10-602.

3.2.2.2. AETC Acquisition Transformation (AETC/A5Q), and CCIT, is available to assist the IIL through the acquisition process.

3.3. AETC/A5XI is the primary office and first stop for the IIL. AETC/A5XI is the primary contact for communication between the IIL and other innovation organizations (AFWERX, SBIR/STTR, etc.). AETC/A5XI and the CCIT will connect the IIL with AF sponsored innovation organizations.

3.4. AF Sponsored Innovation Organizations:

3.4.1. AFWERX encourages and facilitates connections across industry, academia, and the military to foster innovation. AFWERX administers the DAF SBIR/STTR program. The Small Business Innovation Research (SBIR) program funds research and development (R&D) by small businesses of 500 or fewer employees. The Small Business Technology Transfer (STTR) program funds cooperative R&D projects with small businesses and non-profit U.S. research institutions, such as universities.

3.4.1.1. Entering a SBIR/STTR Phase I/II with a company does not constitute a follow-on funding commitment from AETC.

3.4.1.2. SBIR/STTR Phase I. Customer Delivery - the company is contracted for a period of performance to determine if their solution addresses an Air Force need and to plan out a phase II trial with the Air Force customer.

3.4.1.3. SBIR/STTR Phase II. Proof of Concept - the company or academic institution receives money and time to make necessary adaptations and developments on their existing non-defense solution to be useful to the Air Force customer. Companies may receive additional funding during phase II to perform additional work and scale their solutions.

3.4.2. See AFWERX Handbook or the AFWERX SBIR/STTR Website at **https://afwerx.com/wp-content/uploads/Innovation-Handbook.pdf** for further information.

3.4.2.1. AETC/A5XI can assist in navigation of the AFWERX submission process and timelines.

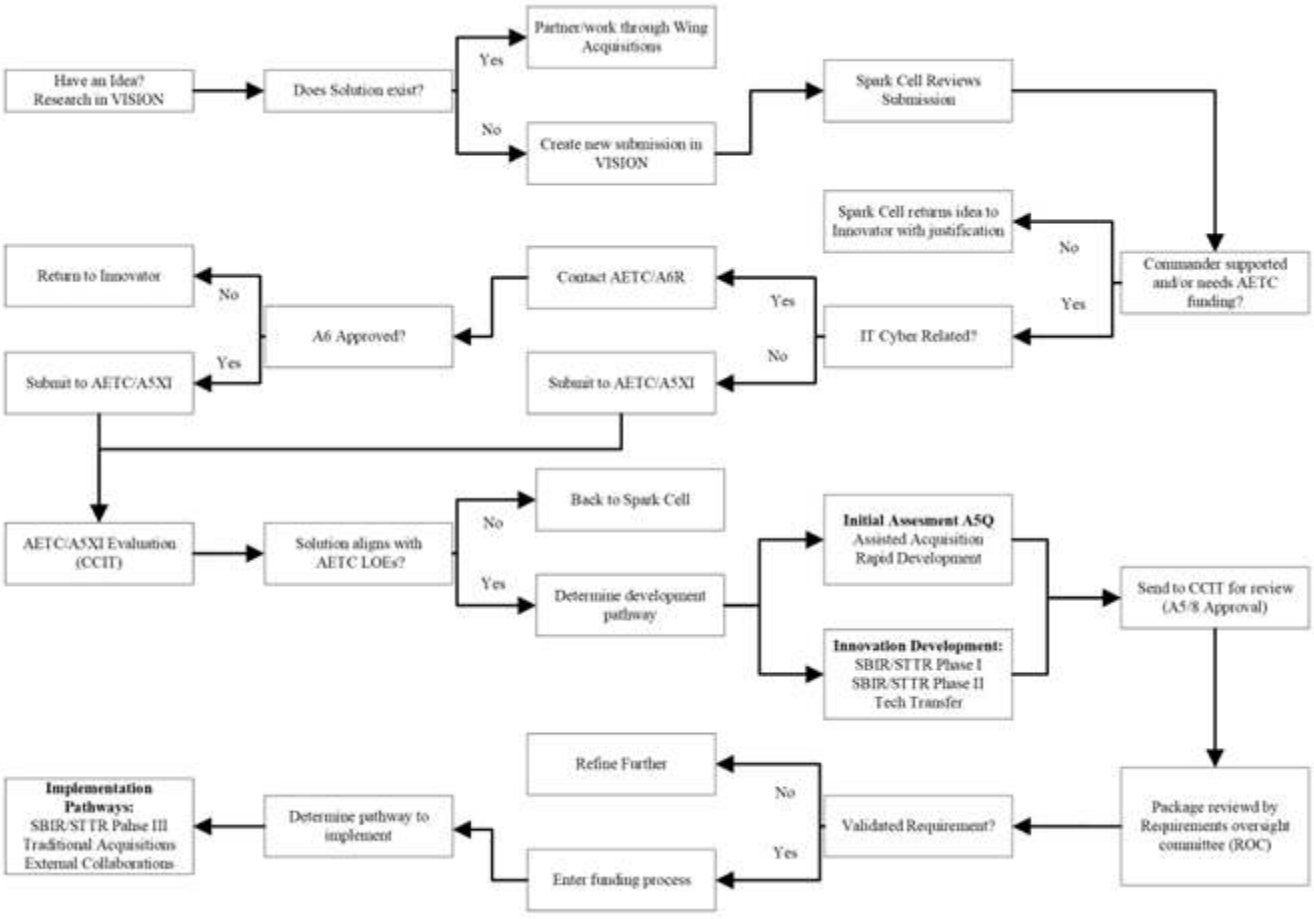
3.4.2.2. To pursue a SBIR/STTR Phase III at the MAJCOM level requires AETC funding. An innovation initiative also requires a validated requirement as well as sponsorship through the HQ AETC Requirement Validation Process.

3.4.2.3. SBIR/STTR Phase I/II do not require AETC funding and entities may pursue them after notification and subsequent approval by AETC/A5XI.

4. Innovation Initiative Pathways.

4.1. AETC's innovation governance defines alternative pathways for an idea, gap, or solution to potentially become a program in AETC. To become a program of record, a requirement must be a validated requirement through the AETC Requirement Validation Process (see **Figure 2**.).

Figure 2. Example Innovation Initiative Pathway.



4.2. Innovation initiatives brought to the Requirement Oversight Committee (ROC) must first have a complete Requirement Package to include a funding request.

4.2.1. AETC/A5XI is available to support the IIL through the AETC Requirements Validation Process in AETCI 10-602

4.2.2. Financial requests are in the form of funding to innovate (FM) or funding to acquire, contract, and sustain through execution year funds (FM) or FYDP funds (POM).

4.3. Assisted Acquisitions and Rapid Development Pathway.

4.3.1. AETC Acquisition Transformation (AETC/A5Q) will assist the IIL to understand the acquisition process and develop an acquisition strategy to transition an approved requirement from innovation phase to execution and sustainment, if available or required.

4.3.2. AETC/A5Q will work with a contracting agency (i.e. 338 ESS) to determine appropriate contract vehicle.

4.3.3. If there is no existing contract vehicle, then AETC/A5Q will support through traditional acquisition process.

4.4. SBIR Phase III Pathway.

4.4.1. The innovation initiative passed a SBIR Phase I/II and is a proven solution.

4.4.2. SBIR/STTR phase III will require an end user agreement. The End User should sponsor innovation up to the Requirement Oversight Committee (ROC) for approval.

4.4.3. Any project that graduated to a SBIR Phase III is available for commercial purchase. IILs and Wings can contact their Wing Financial Manager (FM) to purchase with execution year money. Should the Wing want to acquire the solution for a longer-term contract, the unit must coordinate with local or MAJCOM acquisitions teams as well as FM to ensure sustainment of the commercial product. (See **https://www.sbir.gov** for more information).

4.4.4. For more information on the SBIR/STTR process go to **https://www.sbir.gov/about** or **https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/22780/Topic%20Submission%20Module/Home.aspx**.

4.5. Acquisition of Commercial Products.

4.5.1. Used when the innovation imitative has an identified solution available through a government or commercial product without an existing contract vehicle.

4.5.2. Innovation Initiative Lead will utilize Wing's local acquisition process for procurement in accordance with Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) Part 212.

4.6. External to AETC Efforts Pathway. Innovation efforts are continuously ongoing across the DoD. Partnership opportunities with outside entities are available to the command. Types of partnership include but not limited to:

4.6.1. Collaboration Agreements. Collaboration agreements may document interest and responsibilities from two or more parties on a project considered for additional DAF SBIR/STTR funding. This special award would either be a modification of a current SBIR/STTR Phase II award for a Sequential Phase II award that continues already established development and/or enhancement on the original Phase II award.

4.6.1.1. Customer(s) is the primary organization with the SBIR agreement and commits funds and/or additional resources for the duration of the contract.

4.6.1.2. End-User(s) is an organization that will use the developed solution or will benefit from the solution. Obligation of resources is not required from the end-user to participate unless otherwise annotated on the agreement.

4.6.2. Technology Transfer (T2). The mission of the Department of the Air Force Technology Transfer and Transition Program Office (DAFT3PO) is to facilitate the implementation of Air Force innovative technologies in products and services to benefit the warfighter and the public, while supporting Air Force Research through collaborative partnerships. The DAFT3PO encourages the private sector to use their technologies along with Air Force and Space Force technologies through T2 mechanisms such as CRADAs, EPAs, and PIAs.

4.6.2.1. Cooperative Research and Development Agreements (CRADA). The Air Force may enter CRADAs with private companies, research institutions, or other government agencies to collaborate on research and development efforts. These agreements can involve shared resources and expertise to advance innovation.

4.6.2.2. Partnership Intermediary Agreement (PIA). Many federal laboratories have PIAs with entities that facilitate joint projects and accelerate technology transfer between the lab and private companies. These intermediaries help companies to identify federal technologies for potential licensing and commercialization. They also work to increase the likelihood of successful cooperative activities between the lab and small businesses.

4.7. AETC/A5XI will coordinate with the external organization and perform an assessment with the CCIT team to determine if proposed solution is in alignment with AETC LOEs or if the capability already exist.

5. Innovation Initiatives Tracking Systems.

5.1. VISION (**https://vision.il4.afwerx.dso.mil**). AETC requires each echelon to ensure their Innovation Initiative Leads submits solutions using the VISION platform for innovation accounting and command-level resource sponsorship. Using this platform reduces duplication of effort and encourages collaboration across the Department of the Air Force (DAF), while enabling Airmen to develop solutions with a holistic approach.

5.2. The Guardian and Airmen Innovation Network (G.A.I.N.) (**https://gain.il4.afwerx.dso.mil**). Allows Airmen and Guardians to share ideas, critique submissions, and up vote the most promising solutions for specific VCSAF innovation challenges (Spark Tank, Specific Topic, Open Topic, etc.).

6. Innovation Resources.

6.1. The AF Innovation Ecosystem. A vast and constantly evolving to ensure that solutions can move at the speed of relevancy to solve simple or complex issues that Airmen or Guardians may encounter. Specific programs may vary, but they share the common elements of fostering technological advancements, research, and development to ensure that the AF maintains and advances its strategic portfolio; providing resources and funding mechanisms to support innovation; and ensure the capturing and sharing of solutions. Note: This list is not all inclusive and not all options may be available to AETC.

6.2. DAF resources to support innovation include:

6.2.1. The Defense Innovation Unit (DIU). Strengthens national security by accelerating the adoption of commercial technology throughout the military and bolstering allied and US national security innovation bases. DIU partners with organizations across the Department of Defense (DoD) to rapidly prototype and field dual-use capabilities that solve operational challenges at speed and scale. **https://www.diu.mil/solutions/portfolio/catalog**

6.2.2. Research, Development, Test, and Evaluation (RDT&E) Funding. The DAF allocates RDT&E funds to support research, technology development, testing, and evaluation of new systems, equipment, and technologies. These funds are critical for exploring and maturing new ideas and technologies before integrating them into operational use.

6.2.3. Squadron Innovation Funds (SIF). The DAF established these funds for each component (Active Duty, Air National Guard, and Air Force Reserve) providing Wing Commanders with discretionary O&M resources to invest in the most innovative ideas their Airmen bring forward to increase readiness and lethality. Wing Commanders have complete control over allocating SIF to wing innovations and are free to innovate at the lowest level. Each Wing will report its use of SIF through its leadership chain and to AETC/A5XI to maintain innovation awareness and reduce duplication of effort.

6.2.4. Momentum Funds (MF). The Chief of Staff of the Air Force (CSAF) and Chief of Space Operations (CSO) have continued to support innovation by establishing the MF for each fiscal year. They intend for these funds to support CSAF and CSO strategic innovation priorities.

6.2.5. Rapid Prototyping/Prototyping Initiatives. HAF may allocate funds for rapid prototyping or specific prototyping initiatives. These initiatives aim quickly to develop and test prototypes of new systems or technologies to assess feasibility and potential impact on Air Force operations.

6.2.6. SBIR/STTR Programs. The US Government instituted these programs to stimulate innovation and research within small businesses by providing them with opportunities to participate in federal research and development efforts, including those by the Air Force.

6.2.7. R.A.P.I.Dx. A decentralized network of collaborative contracting cells across the Air Force that specialize in sustaining both innovation and emergent technologies. Their mission is to achieve unity of effort between internally relevant procurement professionals and externally relevant solutions that immediately bolster business agility across a broader DoD and economic spectrum.

6.2.8. Strategic Funding Increase (STRATFI) & Tactical Funding Increase (TACFI) Programs. The AFVentures program developed STRATFI and TACFI funding to help bridge the “Valley of Death” between phase II and Phase III. Small businesses that were awarded a Phase II contract within the last two years are eligible to apply for this annual notice of opportunity. The program requires various levels of matching funding and avenues for Defense and/or Industry matching, depending on the program.

6.2.9. AFWERX. The innovation arm of the DAF and powered by the Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL). AFWERX teams internationally across academia, industry, and government to develop technology, expand talent and transition dual-use capabilities.

6.2.10. AFWERX Refinery "Innovation Accelerator." Intensive course provided to Airmen and Guardian innovators with entrepreneurial knowledge, connections to relevant stakeholders and resources within the DoD ecosystem. The DAF competitively selects innovators and project teams to participate in a 2, 4, or 6-week cohort (based on team needs) to focus on development and refinement of their grassroots project prototypes.

6.3. Contact AETC/A5XI at **AETC.A5XI.Innovation@us.af.mil** for any further assistance.

BRIAN S. ROBINSON, Lt Gen, USAF
Commander, Air Education and Training Command

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFPD 38-4, Continuous Improvement and Airmen Powered by Innovation Program*, 23 August 2018*

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

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DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, 18 October 2023

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DFARS Part 212, *Acquisition of Commercial Products and Commercial Services*, 30 May 2024

AFWERX Handbook

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFPD—Air Force Policy Directive

ATT—Assisted Transition Team

CCIT—Commercial Capabilities Integration & Transition

CPI—Continuous Improvement Process

CRADA—Cooperative Research and Development Agreements

DFARS—Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement

ESS—Enterprise Sourcing Squadron

G.A.I.N.—Guardian and Airmen Innovation Network

LOEs—lines of effort

MF—Momentum Funds

PIA—Partnership Intermediary Agreement

POM—Program Objective Memorandum

RDT&E—Research, Development, Test, and Evaluation

ROC—Requirement Oversight Committee

SBIR—Small Business Innovation Research

SIF—Squadron Innovation Funds

S&T—Science & Technology

STRATFI—Strategic Funding Increase

STTR—Small Business Technology Transfer

TACFI—Tactical Funding Increase

USSF—United States Space Force

VISION—Virtual Innovation Support Integration Operations Network

Office Symbols

AETC/A3X—Air Education and Training Command Future Operations

AETC/A5/8—Air Education and Training Command Strategic Plans, Programs, and Requirements

AETC/A8PP—Air Education and Training Command Programming

AETC/A5Q—Air Education and Training Command Acquisition Transformation

AETC/A5QE—Air Education and Training Command Rapid Development Branch and Acquisitions

AETC/A5RT—Air Education and Training Command Tech Training Requirements

AETC/A5X—Air Education and Training Command Futures Innovation and Strategy

AETC/A5XI—Air Education and Training Command Innovation

AETC/A6CR—Air Education and Training Command Strategic Portfolio Management

AETC/A6FS—Air Education and Training Command Strategy

AETC/A9—Air Education and Training Command Analysis and Assessments

AETC/CC—Commander, Air Education and Training Command

AETC/FM—Air Education and Training Command Financial Management

AETC/FMA—Air Education and Training Command Financial Analysis

Attachment 2

INNOVATION INITIATIVE CRITERIA

Table A2.1. Innovation Initiative Criteria.

With which AETC LOE or LOEs does this identified solution align?			**Score**
Criteria	**Elements** **Scoring: 0 – Not Observed, 1 – Slight Aligned, 2 – Moderately Aligned, 3 – Greatly Aligned**		
1. Alignment with Strategic Objectives:	- Does the proposed solution directly address the identified strategic gap?	- How well does it align with the overall strategic objectives of the organization or military?	
2. Feasibility:	- Is the proposed solution technically feasible and achievable within the given resources and timeline?	- Are there any potential obstacles or challenges that could hinder its implementation?	
3. Effectiveness:	- How effective is the proposed solution in addressing the strategic gap?	- Does it have the potential to significantly improve the organization's capabilities or operational readiness?	
4. Cost and Resource Requirements:	- What are the estimated costs associated with implementing the proposed solution?	- Are the required resources (financial, human, technological) available or obtainable?	
5. Risk Assessment:	- What are the potential risks and uncertainties associated with the proposed solution?	- How likely are these risks to occur, and what would be their impact on the organization or military?	
6. Scalability and Sustainability:	- Can the proposed solution be scalable or expandable to meet future needs?	- Is it sustainable in the long term, considering factors such as maintenance, upgrades, and evolving threats?	
7. Interoperability and Integration:	- How well does the proposed solution integrate with existing systems, processes, and capabilities?	- Does it enhance interoperability with partner organizations or allies?	
8. Stakeholder Engagement:	- Have relevant stakeholders, such as military leaders, subject matter experts, and end-users, been involved in the development and evaluation of the proposed solution?	- Were relevant stakeholder perspectives and feedback considered?	
9. Evaluation and Measurement:	- How will the effectiveness and impact of the proposed solution be evaluated and measured?	- Are there specific metrics or indicators that can be used to assess its success?	
10. Implementation Plan:	- Is there a clear and comprehensive plan for implementing the proposed solution?	- Does the plan include key milestones, responsibilities, and timelines?	
By using this rubric, one can systematically evaluate and assess the proposed solution's suitability for filling the identified strategic gap.			